

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE

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OFFICE OF OPEN-SOURCE INTELLIGENCE MAPPING

INTELLIGENCE MEMORANDUM

Subject: THE 1953 TRUST — Public-Source Entity, Fiduciary, and Residue Map

Memorandum No.: STRAND-1953-C001

Cycle: 001 (inaugural permanent-agency hourly run)

Date of memorandum: 23 September 2026

Classification marking (simulated): UNCLASSIFIED // FOR EDUCATIONAL USE

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Lanes run: HOOK (current reporting) · STAMP (court identifiers) · SPLIT (entity graph) · WEFT (patterns/gaps)

Method law: D-LAW-01 no-mirror; D-LAW-02 hivemind after independent moves; D-LAW-14 thinking gate.

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I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The 1953 Trust is a pour-over revocable trust created under U.S. Virgin Islands law on 8 August 2019 by Jeffrey E. Epstein (b. 1953) as grantor, with Darren K. Indyke and Richard D. Kahn named as trustees. The same day, Epstein executed a last will directing all property into the Trust. He died two days later, on 10 August 2019, at the Metropolitan Correctional Center in New York. The will was filed in the Probate Division of the Superior Court of the Virgin Islands on or about 15 August 2019. A Certificate of Trust was reported filed 26 August 2019.

Until January–February 2026 the beneficiary schedule was not public. A 32-page trust instrument included in the Justice Department's large-scale Epstein-file release (reported ~3 million pages) was then summarized by The New York Times (3 Feb 2026), ABC News (30 Jan 2026), Business Insider, CNN, and others. Press accounts describe 40–44 intended beneficiaries and intended bequests totaling on the order of \$288–\$350 million plus real property—far above residual estate assets now reported in the low-to-mid \$100 millions.

Residue is subordinate to creditors, taxes, administration expenses, and victim claims. Public reporting through 21 September 2026 states the estate has paid on the order of \$170 million to victims (CNN calculation), \$105 million plus island-sale proceeds to the Government of the Virgin Islands (2022 settlement), and that a proposed \$25–\$35 million executor class settlement (Ward v. Indyke and Kahn) had a final-approval hearing scheduled 16 September 2026. Counsel for the executors stated it will likely take at least three more years to complete probate and that neither Indyke nor Kahn has received Trust distributions.

II. HOOK LANE — REVERSE CHRONOLOGY (PUBLIC)

2026 (most current)

- **21 Sep 2026 (CNN):** Estate assets reported at approximately \$107.6 million. Victim payments ~\$170 million since 2019. Valar Ventures holdings (2015–16 \$40 million investment) testified by Indyke as now ~\$172 million, expiring 2026; realization uncertain. Counsel: ≥3 years remaining in probate; no Trust payouts to Indyke/Kahn yet.

- **16 Sep 2026:** Scheduled final-approval hearing on proposed executor class settlement (\$25M if <40 claimants; \$35M if ≥40). Outcome not independently confirmed in this cycle.
- **Jul–Aug 2026 secondary analyses:** 27th estate accounting (docketed ~31 Jul 2026) cited as showing \$107,644,728.02 gross assets as of 30 Jun 2026 (cash ~\$25.7M; majority in private entities). Sep 2025 accounting cited at \$127,402,426.84.
- **3 Feb 2026 (NYT):** First major press synthesis of the 1953 Trust instrument from DOJ files. Shuliak \$100M intended (\$50M + \$50M annuity + property); Indyke \$50M; Kahn \$25M; Maxwell \$10M; Mark Epstein \$10M (for children per some accounts); Martin Nowak \$5M (name misspelled in instrument).
- **30–31 Jan 2026 (ABC / NY Post):** Trust agreement newly public via DOJ Friday release. ≥44 beneficiaries; ~\$288M plus properties intended. Estate residual then cited at \$127M in USVI probate accounting. Larry Visoski \$10M. Properties largely already sold.
- **15 Jan 2025 (NYT, prior cycle context still live):** \$111.6M IRS refund (fall 2024) had swollen assets toward ~\$145M. Kahn deposition (spring 2023) called the Trust “poorly drafted” and declined to name beneficiaries at that time.

2019–2024 (selected public waypoints)

- **Sep 2024:** IRS estate-tax refund ~\$111.6–\$112 million after over-estimated asset values on the estate-tax return.
- **Aug 2023:** Zorro Ranch (New Mexico) reported sold (~\$18–20 million). Public reporting later states all major Epstein real estate has been liquidated.
- **Dec 2022:** Estate–USVI settlement: \$105 million cash, \$450,000 environmental remediation, plus half the proceeds attributable to Little St. James.
- **2020–2021:** Epstein Victims’ Compensation Program — public figures ~\$121 million to 136 women (program closed 2021). USVI AG civil action (ST-20-CV-155 and related) names Indyke and Kahn as executors and administrators of the 1953 Trust, plus entities Plan D LLC, Great St. Jim LLC, Nautilus Inc., Hyperion Air LLC, Poplar Inc., Southern Trust Company Inc.
- **Apr 2020 (WSJ, later archive):** Reporting that another Epstein trust received ~\$13 million investment proceeds and that more than half of that trust’s funds later moved into new trusts (decanting), with Indyke and Kahn among beneficiaries of the receiving vehicles, per USVI motion.
- **31 Aug 2020:** Latham et al. v. The 1953 Trust et al., S.D.N.Y. 1:20-cv-07102 (LLS). Pro se / IFP civil-rights complaint naming The 1953 Trust among dozens of defendants. Dismissed 18 Sep 2020 under 28 U.S.C. § 1915(e)(2)(B)(i) as frivolous. Closed. Not a merits adjudication of the Trust.
- **26 Aug 2019:** Certificate of Trust filed in USVI probate; fiduciaries disclosed, beneficiary list omitted at that time.
- **15 Aug 2019:** Will filed, Superior Court of the Virgin Islands, St. Thomas probate division.
- **10 Aug 2019:** Death of grantor. Kahn signature on trust papers reported same day in some secondary reconstructions; Indyke signature on will reported 18 Aug 2019; Kahn the following day (press accounts differ on which instrument).
- **8 Aug 2019:** Will and 1953 Trust / amended-and-restated trust agreement executed at MCC. Witnesses publicly named in later reporting: attorneys Mariel Colón Miró and Gulnora Tari; notary Mariana A. Melendez (secondary reconstruction). Prior January 2019 trust and a mid-year revision are described in secondary “three-version” reconstructions (EFTA00099303).

III. STAMP LANE — COURT AND DOCUMENT IDENTIFIERS

Identifier	Forum / source	Public fact
Will of Jeffrey E. Epstein (8 Aug 2019)	Superior Court of the Virgin Islands, Probate Division, St. Thomas	Pour-over will; residuary to The 1953 Trust; executors Indyke & Kahn; filed ~15 Aug 2019
The 1953 Trust Agreement (8 Aug 2019)	DOJ Epstein-file production; Bates EFTA01266204 / EFTA00099303 (as cited in press)	32-page instrument; grantor Epstein; trustees Indyke & Kahn; priority bequests; in terrorism clause (secondary)

Certificate of Trust (~26 Aug 2019)	USVI probate	Fiduciaries named; beneficiaries omitted from that certificate
GVI v. Estate of Jeffrey Epstein et al.	USVI Super. Ct.; public exhibit archive.org 07.13.2020.001 ST 20 CV 155	Names Trust + executors + Plan D, Great St. Jim, Nautilus, Hyperion Air, Poplar, Southern Trust Co.
Latham v. 1953 Trust, 20-cv-7102 (LLS)	S.D.N.Y.	Filed 31 Aug 2020; dismissed 18 Sep 2020 § 1915(e)(2)(B)(i); closed
Ward v. Indyke and Kahn (executor class)	Federal (SDNY reporting)	Proposed \$25–35M settlement; final hearing noticed 16 Sep 2026
Estate quarterlies / 27th accounting	USVI probate docket	30 Jun 2026 snapshot cited \$107.64M gross; 30 Sep 2025 snapshot cited \$127.40M

IV. SPLIT LANE — ENTITY AND PERSON GRAPH (PUBLIC)

A. Core fiduciary triangle

Grantor: Jeffrey Edward Epstein (1953–2019). Residence recited as Little St. James Island, St. Thomas, USVI. **Trustees / co-executors:** Darren K. Indyke (longtime personal counsel; public reporting of work for Epstein since at least 1995) and Richard D. Kahn (longtime accountant; public reporting since ~2005). LittleSis interlock map (org 366728, updated ~early 2026) also places both men at The C.O.U.Q. Foundation, Inc.; Poplar Inc.; Gratitude America Ltd.; plus Indyke at Gold & Wachtel, Parlatore Law Group, Florida Science Foundation, Max Hotel Services Corp., Wexner Foundation, Epstein Interests; Kahn at RDK Asset Management Inc., HBRK Associates Inc., Estate of Jeffrey E. Epstein. **Alternate executor named in some will reporting:** Boris Nikolic (publicly said he was “shocked” to learn of the designation).

B. Intended priority beneficiaries as reported from the 2026 DOJ-file release

Press syntheses are not a certified beneficiary register. Amounts are intended gifts, not paid distributions. Residual assets are insufficient to fund the full schedule; the instrument is reported to pay in listed order and treat later gifts as lapsed if funds fail. Fourteen names are described as redacted in at least one EFTA reconstruction.

#	Name (public press)	Intended gift (press)	Public role / note
1	Karyna Shuliak	\$50M cash + \$50M annuity; properties; ~33-ct diamond; 48 loose diamonds (hand note)	Described as girlfriend / contemplated spouse; last known call from jail
2	Darren K. Indyke	\$50M (up from \$20M in earlier 2019 draft per secondary reconstruction)	Co-trustee / co-executor; loan-forgiveness items reported (Harlequin Dane LLC / Southern Financial)
3	Richard D. Kahn	\$25M (up from \$20M in earlier draft per secondary reconstruction)	Co-trustee / co-executor
—	Ghislaine Maxwell	\$10M	Associate; serving federal sentence for sex trafficking
—	Mark Epstein	\$10M (some accounts: held for his children)	Brother; sole remaining heir named in the 2019 will narrative
—	Larry Visoski	\$10M	Longtime pilot
—	Martin Nowak	\$5M	Harvard mathematician; name misspelled in instrument per NYT
—	Cecile de Jongh	\$1M	Former USVI First Lady; Epstein employee in some reporting; cited in USVI AG theory of influence
—	Michelle Fern Saipher	\$3M (secondary reconstruction; repay KCAC/FT Real Estate obligations)	Reported spouse of Indyke

Related named vehicles in public complaints and interlock maps: Plan D, LLC; Great St. Jim, LLC; Nautilus, Inc.; Hyperion Air, LLC; Poplar, Inc.; Southern Trust Company, Inc.; Gratitude America Ltd.; The C.O.U.Q. Foundation, Inc.; RDK Asset Management Inc.; HBRK Associates Inc.; Harlequin Dane, LLC; Southern Financial, LLC; Valar Ventures funds (investment holdings, not Trust vehicles).

V. WEFT LANE — PATTERNS, ANOMALIES, ONTOLOGY

Patterns

- Birth-year naming + same-day pour-over will + two-day interval to death is the public origin story of the vehicle.
- Identity fusion of executor, trustee, and high-priority beneficiary in the same two natural persons is the central governance pattern (and the core of public conflict-of-interest allegations by the USVI AG and later class plaintiffs). Executors deny knowledge of trafficking and state they have received no Trust money.
- Priority waterfall + lapse clause means residual math, not the 2019 gift schedule, will decide who is paid. First three intended gifts already exceed currently reported gross assets.
- Decanting / successor-trust language in 2020 USVI papers (WSJ) is a second pattern: movement of assets among related trusts with overlapping beneficiaries, described by an investment adviser letter as insulation from claims — itself a litigated characterization, not a proven fact in this memo.
- Public-to-private opacity cycle: 2019 certificate hid names; 2026 DOJ dump revealed a schedule; redactions and draft-version conflicts remain.

Anomalies / tensions in the public record

- Kahn 2023 deposition: Trust “poorly drafted,” remainder-distribution intent unclear — versus a 2026 instrument that press treats as a detailed numbered bequest list. Reconcile draft versions (Jan 2019 vs Aug 2019 vs any intervening restatement).
- Signature-date scatter across press (Kahn on 10 Aug vs 19 Aug; Indyke on 18 Aug) needs primary-document confirmation from the EFTA PDF itself.
- Bates collision: EFTA01266204 (32-page) vs EFTA00099303 (long reconstruction). Possible that one is the trust and one is a composite / will+trust packet.
- Estate-value path is non-monotonic: ~\$577–\$655M (2019) → projected <\$40M → +\$112M IRS refund → \$145M → \$127M (Sep 2025) → \$107.6M (mid-2026) with a still-unrealized Valar mark of ~\$172M testified. Marks-to-market vs distributable cash must be separated.
- Latham 20-cv-7102 is a noise node: names the Trust but is a dismissed kitchen-sink IFP complaint and should not be treated as a merits source.

VI. OPEN GAPS (PERMANENT MISSION CONTINUES)

- G-01 Certified unredacted beneficiary schedule (all 40–44 names) from primary EFTA PDF, not press paraphrase.
- G-02 Full USVI probate docket number and latest official accounting PDF (27th accounting) — cash vs entity vs liability split.
- G-03 Outcome of 16 Sep 2026 Ward settlement final-approval hearing.
- G-04 Valar Ventures 2026 maturity / distribution into the estate (amount actually received vs mark).
- G-05 Status of any remaining USVI, IRS, or private claims that still block pour-over completion.
- G-06 Primary text of in terrorem / no-contest and lapse provisions.
- G-07 January 2019 predecessor trust and any February–August 2019 restatement — delta table of names and amounts from primary pages.
- G-08 Certificate of Trust (26 Aug 2019) image from the probate file.
- G-09 Entity roster (Plan D, Great St. Jim, Nautilus, Hyperion Air, Poplar, Southern Trust Co., Gratitude America, C.O.U.Q.) — formation jurisdiction, status, and whether each still holds estate value.
- G-10 Whether residual will terminate the Trust or continue it as a private vehicle after probate (court-dependent).
- G-11 Alternate-executor Nikolic instrument language.
- G-12 LittleSis interlock freshness vs 2026 filings (Wexner Foundation / Parlature / Florida Science Foundation edges).

VII. HIVEMIND UPGRADE AND AUTONOMOUS NEXT STEPS

Independent lanes did not copy methods: HOOK worked reverse-chronology press; STAMP worked identifiers and dismissed-vs-live dockets; SPLIT built the person/entity graph and interlocks; WEFT scored pattern vs anomaly and refused single-lens stories (D-LAW-04, D-LAW-05). Shared after the moves: the binding constraint is not the 2019 gift list but the USVI residual + claim waterfall. Next cycle should privilege primary PDFs over aggregator blogs.

- NS-1 Pull EFTA01266204 / EFTA00099303 from the public DOJ Epstein-file corpus (already-released) and extract a first-party beneficiary table.
- NS-2 Retrieve the latest USVI probate accounting PDF and tabulate assets/liabilities.
- NS-3 Confirm Ward final-approval minute order after 16 Sep 2026.
- NS-4 Open-court search only for successor-trust / decanting instruments referenced in the 2020 USVI papers.
- NS-5 Entity-status sweep (USVI, DE, NY SOS / corporations registries) for the six complaint entities.
- NS-6 Do not treat Latham as operationally relevant beyond a closed docket stamp.

VIII. SOURCES (PUBLIC; SELECTED)

- The New York Times, “Jeffrey Epstein’s Trust Reveals Beneficiaries of His Fortune,” 3 Feb 2026 (Goldstein).
- The New York Times, “Jeffrey Epstein’s Will: He Signed 2 Days Before Killing Himself,” 19 Aug 2019 (Eder & Watkins).
- The New York Times, “Jeffrey Epstein’s Associates Could Reap Benefit of a Big Tax Refund,” 15 Jan 2025.
- ABC News, “How Epstein planned to dole out his millions, new documents show,” 30 Jan 2026.
- CNN, “Epstein’s closest advisers may never see the millions he left them,” 21 Sep 2026.
- Wall Street Journal (archived), “The CPA and the Lawyer Who Served Jeffrey Epstein...,” Nov 2025.
- Wikipedia, “Estate of Jeffrey Epstein” (accessed 23 Sep 2026; tertiary).
- LittleSis.org 366728, The 1953 Trust interlocks.
- UniCourt / Leagle: Latham v. 1953 Trust, No. 20-cv-7102 (S.D.N.Y. 2020).
- Archive.org, GVI first amended complaint exhibit (ST-20-CV-155).
- Business Insider, 2 Feb 2026 (Shuliak / draft comparison).
- Secondary reconstructions citing EFTA Bates numbers are used only as leads to primary pages (G-01).

Prepared by STRAND HOOK/STAMP/SPLIT/WEFT hivemind, Cycle 001, 23 September 2026. Permanent mission remains open while G-01 through G-12 are unresolved. Re-run hourly. Public-source ceiling unchanged.